Saturday, October 7

Unbelievable! The country is under attack! Hamas has deeply penetrated southern Israel along the border with Gaza. Total surprise and complete pandemonium. Apparently no one saw it coming.

Initial reports mention tens of Israelis dead—maybe hundreds—and dozens of inhabitants from border communities taken hostage and likely taken to Gaza. The replay of October 1973 in October 2023 has taken Israel by complete surprise: the government was asleep, the army was asleep, the specialists who bombard us every day with interpretations of what the Arabs are going to do were all taken by surprise not only with their pants down, but asleep and without their pants …

What a disgrace, mainly for Israel's military intelligence, the Shin Bet and the Mossad. And, of course, for Netanyahu and Gallant. Retaliation will be complicated because of the hostages who are now in the hands of Hamas. On top of everything, Israel is in deep internal turmoil, rent between various hostile factions and an internally weakened army.

Hezbollah in the North is probably waiting for the bulk of our forces to move south before opening a second front. Hundreds of thousands of Israelis are being mobilized. The civilian population is in for a very tough time.

Gantz is ready to join Netanyahu's coalition without conditions. Lapid will join if Smotrich and Ben-Gvir are shown the door. I think he is right. It is taking an interminably long time to clear the Sderot police station that five—yes, five—Hamas militants are holding. Incredible! There are endless questions and everyone in the army keeps mum. Where was our sophisticated intelligence, where was the Mossad, what happened to the technologically advanced "smart fence" built around the Gaza enclave? Of course, heads will roll in due time, and Netanyahu and his wife Sara'le will